

Revised Gold Coast Marathon Training Plan

Updated for: No UTA50 | Gold Coast Marathon – 5 July | Goal: Sub-3 Marathon

Key Changes

- No UTA fatigue to manage → more marathon-specific work
- Increased specificity at marathon pace
- Slightly higher long-run quality
- Maintained 5-day running structure with Monday & Friday off/cross-training

Week 1

Focus: Marathon rhythm and threshold strength

Day	Session
Monday	Rest / mobility / light cross-training
Tuesday	3 × 3 km @ 4:00–4:03/km with 3 min easy jog recovery
Wednesday	10–12 km easy @ 4:55–5:15/km
Thursday	10 km continuous @ marathon pace (~4:15/km)
Friday	Rest
Saturday	28 km long run: first 18 km easy, final 10 km @ 4:15–4:18/km
Sunday	12–14 km easy recovery

Week 2

Focus: Peak aerobic load

Day	Session
Monday	Rest
Tuesday	6 × 1 km @ 3:50–3:55/km with 90 sec jog recovery
Wednesday	12 km easy
Thursday	2 × 6 km @ 4:12–4:15/km with 3 min float jog
Friday	Rest
Saturday	32 km long run: first 20 km easy, final 12 km @ MP
Sunday	10–12 km very easy

Week 3

Focus: Peak specificity

Day	Session
Monday	Rest / mobility
Tuesday	8 km tempo @ 4:02–4:05/km
Wednesday	10 km easy

Thursday	14 km continuous @ marathon pace (~4:14–4:16/km)
Friday	Rest
Saturday	34 km long run: final 12 km @ MP if feeling strong
Sunday	10 km recovery

Week 4

Focus: Absorb fitness and sharpen

Day	Session
Monday	Rest
Tuesday	5 × 1 km @ 10k pace (~3:50/km)
Wednesday	8–10 km easy
Thursday	10 km @ marathon pace
Friday	Rest
Saturday	26 km steady aerobic long run
Sunday	12 km easy

Week 5

Focus: Begin taper

Day	Session
Monday	Rest
Tuesday	4 × 1 km @ marathon pace
Wednesday	8 km easy
Thursday	8 km relaxed with 4 × 20 sec strides
Friday	Rest
Saturday	18–20 km easy
Sunday	10 km easy

Week 6 – Race Week

Focus: Fresh legs and confidence

Day	Session
Monday	Rest
Tuesday	3 × 1 km @ MP with full recovery
Wednesday	8 km easy
Thursday	6 km easy + strides
Friday	Rest
Saturday	4–5 km shakeout
Sunday – 5 July	Gold Coast Marathon

Key Training Notes

- Goal marathon pace: ~4:14–4:15/km
- Easy pace: ~4:55–5:20/km
- Recovery jogs between reps: ~5:15–6:00/km
- Long runs are the highest priority sessions
- Fuel long runs exactly like race day (60–90g carbs/hour)
- Conservative first half marathon split is recommended on race day